## 12.4.6 Eventually consistent data retrieval

By default, reading data from DynamoDB is *eventually consistent*. That means it's possible that if you create an item (version 1), update that item (version 2), and then read that item, you may get back version 1; if you wait and fetch the item again, you'll see version 2. Figure 12.5 shows this process. This behavior occurs because the item is persisted on multiple machines in the background. Depending on which machine answers your request, the machine may not have the latest version of the item.

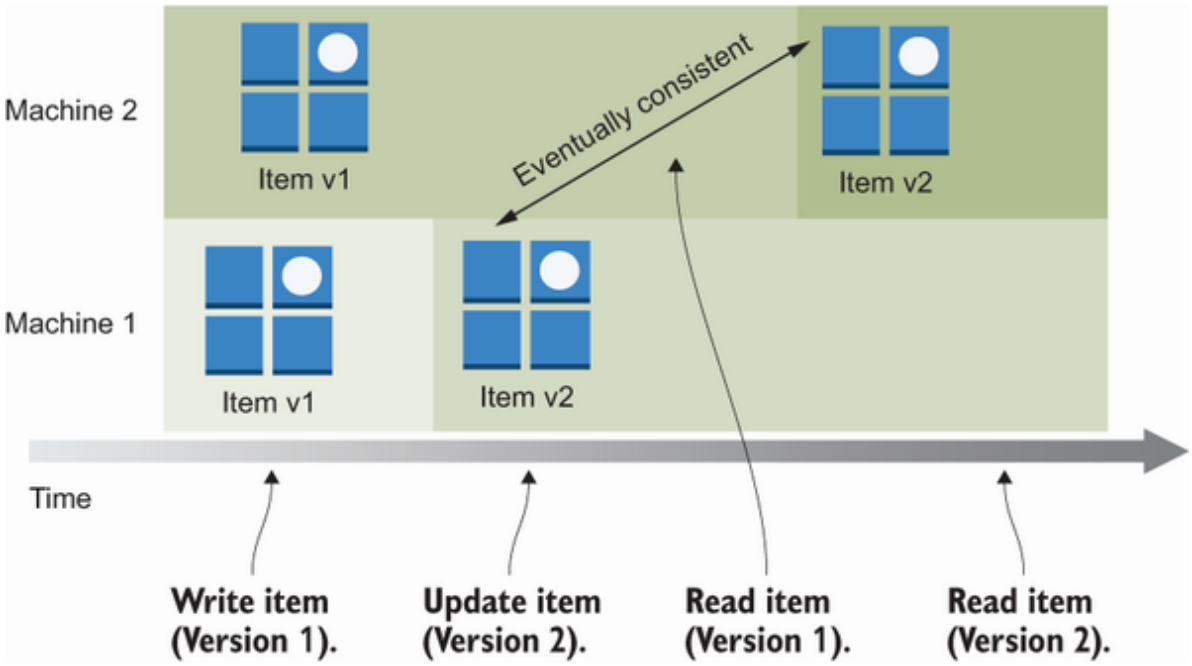



**Figure 12.5 Eventually consistent reads can return old values after a write operation until the change is propagated to all machines.**

You can prevent eventually consistent reads by adding `"ConsistentRead": true` to the DynamoDB request to get *strongly*